Derived lipids:

The hydrolysis products of simple and compound lipids are called derived lipids. For example hydrolysis of triglycerides yields glycerol and fatty acid.

Similarly steroids, fatty aldehydes, ketones, alcohols, fat-soluble vitamins can also be derived from the hydrolysis of simple/compounds lipids.

6.1.2 Biological Functions of lipids:

- Lipids are important components of the cell membrane and are necessary for the structural integrity of the cell.
- They serve as energy reserve of the body.
- They act as a protective coating in aquatic organisms.
- Lipids serve as insulating material on the surface of animals living in extreme cold regions.
- They serve as component of cell recognition, species specificity and tissue immunity.
- They help in the absorption and transport of fat soluble vitamins.



Figure 6.2 Lipid insulation in polar bears

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